Privacy policy

FAM BY FAMILIARIZE · UPDATED 12 OCTOBER 2026

FAM turns what you ask and what you follow into short audio stories. This policy says what FAM keeps about you, who else receives any of it and why, how long it is kept, and how to change or delete it. "FAM", "we" and "us" mean Familiarize, which runs FAM.

The short version

- We keep what FAM needs to work: your account, what you ask and listen to (to make your feeds), and what you post.
- What you ask is sent to Anthropic to write the episode, and a search drawn from it to Parallel and Perplexity to find sources, only after you say yes in the app. Anthropic does not use it to train its models.
- We show no ads, sell nothing, and track you across no other apps or sites.
- You can delete your account at any time in Settings, and it is gone straight away.

What we collect

WHAT	DETAILS	WHY
Account	Email address or phone number, and a password (stored only as a scrypt hash). If you sign in with Google or Apple: the account id they give us, your email and the name on that account.	To sign you in and keep your things with you.
Profile	Display name, @handle and profile picture if you set them; date of birth if you give it; the town, region or country you type in (FAM never reads your device's location).	To show your profile and to suggest stories about where you live.
What you ask and play	Your searches and Go Deeper questions; which episodes you play, finish or skip; what you pick, share, save, vibe or add to a mix; which tiles were shown to you.	To make your episodes and to rank myFAM and DailyFAM for you.

What you post	Comments, messages, vibes and their captions, mixes and their covers, interests you choose, files and links you attach to a search.	To deliver them to the people you meant them for.
Reports and feedback	Content you report and why; bug reports you send, with the screen and app version.	To keep FAM safe and to fix it.
Your AI answer	Whether you allowed your questions to be sent to our AI provider, and when.	So we only send them when you said yes.
Your agreement to the terms	Which version of the terms and this policy you agreed to, when, and from which app.	As the record that you agreed, and so we ask again when they change.
Usage and cost	How many episodes you made and what each cost us to make.	To apply plan limits and to run the service.
Technical	A session cookie (or, in the app, a sign-in token), your time zone on each request, the app version, and the network address our hosting provider records.	To keep you signed in, write episodes in your own time, and keep the service working.

If you listen without an account, FAM keeps no record of what you play.

Who else receives it

We use these companies to run FAM. Each receives only what is listed, only to do that job for us.

WHO	WHAT THEY RECEIVE
Anthropic (Claude)	What you type, say or attach, a Go Deeper question with the episode it follows, your local date and time, and - when you tap the story about where you live - the place you set. Only after you allow it in the app. Also each profile picture and mix cover you save, checked once for nudity, violence and hate symbols before anyone else sees it (the photo editor says so). Anthropic does not train its models on any of it.
Parallel and Perplexity	A web search written from your question (Parallel also gets a one-line description of what it is looking for), to find the sources an episode is built on. Never your name or account. Both may keep searches and use them to improve their services.

Sports, markets and forecast data (BALLDONTLIE, Finnhub, Polymarket)	The subject of a question that needs live facts, such as a team or a company - never who asked.
Weather (Open-Meteo, the US National Weather Service)	A place named in a question, then its coordinates.
RunPod	The words of an episode, to turn into speech. Nothing is stored there.
Render	Hosts FAM's servers and stores its databases.
Viral Loops	If you join the waitlist: your email, display name and invite code, to count invitations.
Google and Apple	Only if you sign in with them; they tell us who you are, we tell them nothing.
Our email provider	If you ask to reset your password: your email address and the message we send it - the reset code, then a note that your password was changed.
Your browser's push service	If you turn notifications on: a short message such as "Your mix is ready".
Your device's speech recognition	If you search by voice, your device (Apple or Google) turns speech into text before FAM sees it.
Google Fonts	Your network address, when a FAM web page loads its typefaces.
The website of a link you attach	A request from FAM's server to read that page.

We do not sell your information or share it for advertising. We would disclose it only if the law required us to.

What other people can see

- **Your profile**: name, @handle, picture, the interests you choose to show, the place you set, your public mixes and your vibes.
- **Comments** can be read by anyone; **messages** only by the people in the conversation.
- **Mixes** are public when you make them; you can make one private.

- **Episodes you search** can be played by other listeners in Explore, without your name unless you turn on "Show my name on episodes I searched". Questions that look personal (with "my", an email address or a phone number) and anything with an attachment are never shared.

How long we keep it

WHAT	FOR HOW LONG
Attached files and images	6 hours
Listening history in Settings	14 days
Which tiles were shown to you	30 days
Plan-limit counters	60 days
Sign-in sessions	90 days after last use
Written episodes	7 days, up to 30 while people keep playing them
Your account, profile, activity, posts and messages	Until you delete them or your account

When you delete your account we erase your account, profile, activity, posts, messages, mixes, saved items, blocks and your AI answer straight away. Episodes you searched stay for other listeners with your name removed. Our cost records, bug reports and content reports are kept with your name removed, because they are records of the service rather than of you. Deleting your account does not remove a waitlist entry from Viral Loops; email us and we will.

Your choices and rights

- Change your profile, place, interests and settings in the app.
- Turn **Send my questions to AI** on or off in Settings, Privacy and safety.
- Block anyone; report anything.
- Delete your account in Settings. It cannot be undone.
- Ask us for a copy of what we hold about you, to correct it, or to delete it, by emailing ian@familiarize.net. Depending on where you live (for example the EU, the UK or

California) these are legal rights, and you may also complain to your data protection authority. We do not sell or share personal information as California law defines it.

Cookies and storage on your device

FAM uses one cookie to keep you signed in. Your device also keeps your playback settings and, so they play without a connection, episodes you have finished. Signing out clears them. There are no advertising or analytics cookies.

Security

Passwords and sign-in tokens are stored only as one-way hashes, and every connection to FAM is encrypted. No system is perfectly secure; if something goes wrong that affects you, we will tell you.

Children

FAM is not meant for children under 13, and we do not knowingly collect their information. If you believe a child has an account, email us and we will delete it.

Where your information is processed

FAM and the companies above process information in the United States and other countries, which may have different data protection laws from yours.

Changes

We will update the date above when this policy changes, and tell you in the app before a change in what is sent to a third party takes effect.

Contact

Email ian@familiarize.net. A person reads every message, and we answer within 24 hours.